

# Definition of Ready vs Definition of Done

A practical template to help Agile teams start work at the right time and finish work with the right quality.

This template is designed for Scrum Masters, Product Owners, and Agile teams to reduce rework, avoid spillovers, and improve delivery predictability.

## WHY THIS MATTERS

Many teams struggle not because of lack of skills, but because work starts too early and finishes too loosely.

**Definition of Ready (DoR)** ensures work enters the Sprint only when it is truly ready.

**Definition of Done (DoD)** ensures work is completed with quality and shared understanding.

### Definition of Ready (DoR)

*A Product Backlog Item is considered READY when all the following conditions are met:*

- ✓ User story is clearly written and understood
- ✓ Acceptance criteria are defined
- ✓ Business value is clear
- ✓ Dependencies are identified
- ✓ Story is estimated
- ✓ Test scenarios are understood
- ✓ No open questions remain

### Definition of Done (DoD)

*A Product Backlog Item is considered DONE only when all the following conditions are met:*

- ✓ Code is complete and merged
- ✓ Code has been reviewed and approved
- ✓ Unit and functional tests have passed
- ✓ No critical defects are open
- ✓ Acceptance criteria are met
- ✓ Integrated with main branch
- ✓ Product Owner has accepted the story

 **Scrum Master Tip**

Definition of Ready and Definition of Done are not documents to be created once and forgotten. They are team agreements that should evolve as the team matures.

For more practical Agile templates, interview preparation, and real-world Scrum guidance, connect on LinkedIn and message the word **DOR**.